



TECHNICAL REFERENCE

Email Automation — How It Works

A plain-language guide to the code that lets you email files (social posts, contracts, plans) from this project straight to the Good Measure inbox — what each piece does, how to trigger it, and its one real limitation.

01

What This Does

When you ask for something to be emailed, a request goes to GitHub, which spins up a temporary computer, runs a small Python script, and that script logs into the Good Measure Gmail account and sends the message with your files attached. Nothing runs on your own computer — GitHub does the sending, on demand.



02

The Three Pieces

- `adhoc-email.yml` — the trigger. Lives in `.github/workflows/`, defines what information is needed (subject, files, captions) and starts the job on GitHub's servers.
 - `send_adhoc_email.py` — the message builder. Takes the subject, intro, file list, and captions, and assembles them into one email (captions get turned into a readable block; every filename gets listed).
 - `_gmail_email.py` — the mailer. Does the actual work of connecting to Gmail, attaching the files, and sending. Every other script reuses this one rather than each writing its own sending logic.
-

03

How It Gets Triggered

Right now, this is triggered by asking me — I run a command that starts the workflow with the files and message you want. The same thing can be triggered by hand from GitHub's website (Actions tab → Ad-hoc Asset Email → Run workflow) if you ever want to send something without me.

```
gh workflow run adhoc-email.yml -f subject="..." -f  
files="path/to/file.pdf"
```



04

The Two Secrets

- `EMAIL_APP_PASSWORD` — a special password (not the real Gmail password) that only allows sending mail as `goodmeasurebarco@gmail.com`. Stored encrypted in GitHub; once set, it can never be viewed again by anyone, including me — only replaced.
- `SOCIAL_EMAIL_TO` — the inbox everything gets sent to. Currently set to `goodmeasurebarco@gmail.com`. Changeable at any time without touching any code.

05

The One Real Limit

This only works on files that already exist in the public GitHub repository. The Contracts folder is deliberately kept out of that repository (so future client information never becomes public), which means sending a filled-in contract needs an extra step: temporarily copying it into the repository, sending it, then removing it again. That workaround is fine for a blank template — it should not become the normal way to send a contract that has real client details on it. If that becomes a regular need, it's worth setting up a separate, local way to send email that never touches GitHub at all.

06

Where Things Live

- `.github/workflows/adhoc-email.yml` — the trigger definition
- `scripts/send_adhoc_email.py` — the message builder
- `scripts/_gmail_email.py` — the mailer (the underscore just marks it as "supporting," not run directly)



Companion to the Good Measure landing page — same palette, type, and layout as the other reference documents.

